PHASE 1 - UNDERSTAND

From a broad challenge to a focused learning agenda

Mass-Affluent Wealth Advice

A visual synthesis of the RBI Innovation School Understand work

1 UNDERSTAND — CURRENT

2 EMPATHIZE — NEXT

3 IDEATE

4 PROTOTYPE & TEST

5 BUSINESS CASE & PITCH

Problem first → evidence second → solution third

Source: 9 RBI Stage-1 prompts + project research. AI-assisted; internal RBI data still pending.

Nine RBI prompts. One coherent Understand phase.

Different lenses on the same question: what problem space are we really investigating?

1

EXPLORE THE LANDSCAPE

Market • competitors • technology

2

ALIGN THE PROBLEM SPACE

Terminology • stakeholders • scope

3

PREPARE THE EVIDENCE

Data sources • analysis • storytelling

Output: shared understanding of the market, journey, stakeholders, boundaries and evidence gaps - not a chosen solution.

Each prompt output is a working input for team discussion, not an AI decision.

Mass affluent sits between standard retail and private banking.

The question is what level of guidance can be delivered at scale.

Retail	Mass affluent	Premium	Private banking
Standard service	Higher income / savings Not a legal category	Service tier May overlap	Highest-touch service Upper boundary

What public research shows

Hungarian banks commonly use Premium thresholds based on income or savings, with personal or video adviser access.

Critical distinction

Mass affluent = who the customer is.
Premium = what service tier the bank gives them.

Possible focus

Customers with meaningful savings but no clear plan - or those just below Premium thresholds - may be underserved. This still needs validation.

Market choice and target customer remain team decisions.

The strongest pattern is not digital OR human - it is the right mix.

Help is increasingly tiered: self-service for scale, human support when complexity or confidence demands it.



Regional pattern

RaiConnect video advice, personal bankers, planning tools and Premium tiers already exist.

Global pattern

Vanguard, Moneyfarm and TurboTax show tiered digital-to-human help.

Implication

The opportunity may be the handover and service design around existing capabilities - not a brand-new robo adviser.

Competitor features are based on advertised public offers, not measured usage or outcomes.

Use technology to amplify judgement - not to pretend judgement disappears.

The strongest current use cases reduce friction, prepare advisers and connect channels.

MAINSTREAM

Robo / hybrid

Rules-based portfolios + human escalation

EMERGING

Adviser copilot

Prep, notes, summaries, follow-up drafts

MAINSTREAM

Goal planning

Start from the customer goal, not a product list

EMERGING

Customer AI

Good for explanation; risky for unsupervised advice

Digital handles repeatable work → **Context travels with the customer** → **Humans handle judgement & trust**

Guardrail: personal recommendations remain regulated advice; AI requires governance and transparency.

Where might customers get stuck today?

A working map to guide research - not an audited RBI customer journey.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Trigger	**Info**	**Channel**	**Questionnaire**	**Proposal**	**Decision**	**Funding**	**Review**
I should do something	Searches for help	App / branch / video	Goals / risk / suitability	Options explained	Sign / confirm	Money moves	Am I still on track?

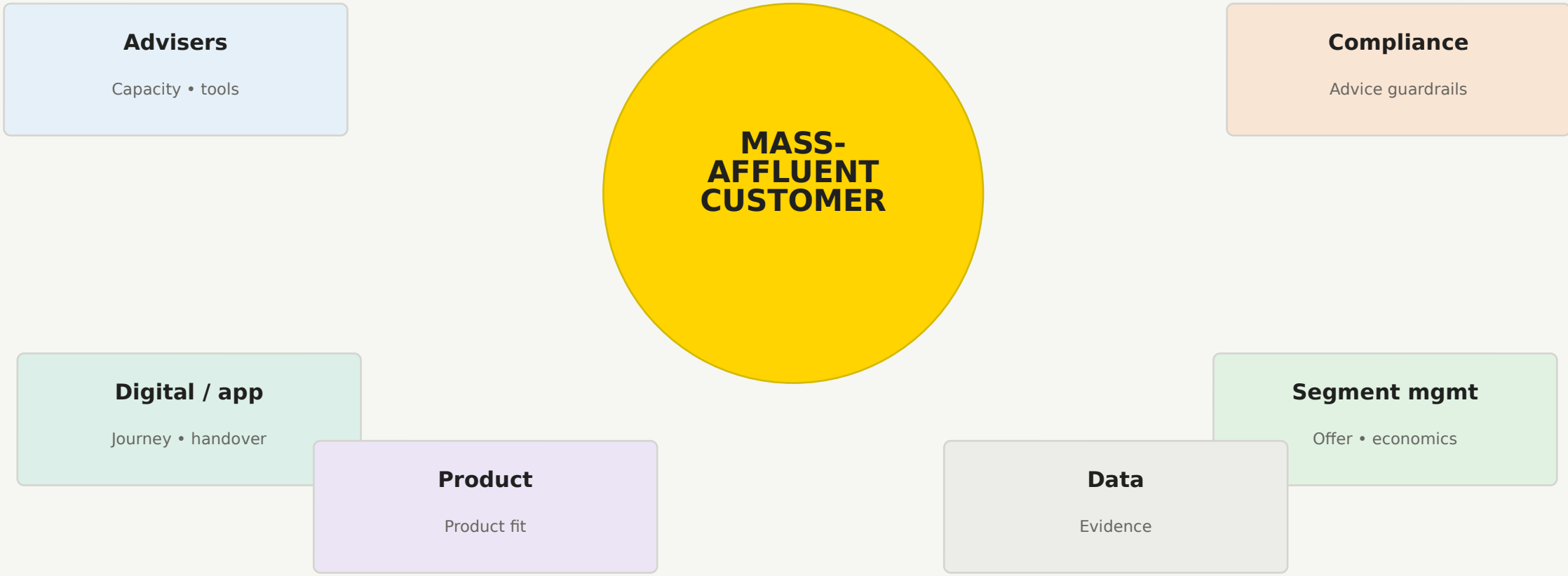
Information overload & low confidence	Questionnaire feels like paperwork	Human handover may be unclear	Drop-off before funding	Weak follow-up / review
H2	REPORTED	H3	UNKNOWN	H1

Phase 1 tells us where to look. Phase 2 must tell us which pain is real, frequent and worth solving.

Reported and inferred pains must be validated with real customers and bankers.

The journey is shaped by people who experience, enable and govern it.

Keep the full journey visible while choosing one market, one customer group and one stage to improve.



Private banking, new investment products, core-system replacement and changes to regulation stay outside the workshop scope.

07 - EVIDENCE GAPS

The honest output of Understand is a learning agenda.

We have public research and expert signals, but no internal RBI data or customer validation yet.

KNOWN / CHECKED

Advice offers exist in RBI markets.
Hybrid models exist in the market.
Regulation shapes what counts as advice.

REPORTED / EXTERNAL

Adviser time and paperwork may constrain service.
External surveys suggest personalisation and switching concerns.

UNKNOWN / MUST VALIDATE

Who exactly is our target?
Where do they actually struggle?
Which problem occurs often enough to solve?

PHASE 1 EXIT GATE

1. **Provisional target customer**
2. **Current journey + possible pains**
3. **Stakeholder / scope boundary**
4. **Questions & hypotheses for Empathize**

Next: Empathize - replace assumptions with real customer and banker evidence, then reframe the problem.